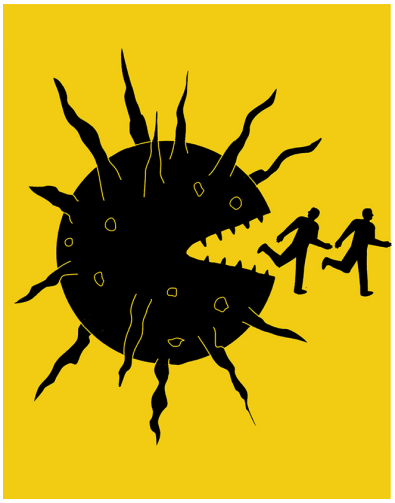


PARASITES AND PATHOGENS CONTROL POPULATIONS LIKE PREDATORS

ECOLOGICAL EPIDEMIOLOGY

IN CONTEXT

KEY FIGURES

Roy Anderson (1947–), **Robert May** (1936–2020)

BEFORE

1662 English statistician John Graunt seeks to classify causes of death in London in *Natural and Political Observations made upon the Bills of Mortality*.

1927 Scottish scientists Anderson Gray McKendrick and William Ogilvy Kermack develop an epidemic model for infected, uninfected, and immune individuals.

AFTER

1996 American epidemiologist James S. Koopman calls for greater use of computational technologies to simulate disease generation and spread.

2018 A global team tracks the origins and spread of a fungus devastating frog populations.

Epidemiology is the study of how disease spreads through a population. Its initial application was to human diseases, but its methods have been recognized as an effective way of modeling populations of other organisms, too.